



Fredrik Pålman

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE & PRODUCT
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Mölndal, Sweden

Senior digital experience and product leader with 12+ years of practice spanning discovery, design strategy, and organisational transformation. Combines modern product thinking with demonstrated capability in complex enterprise environments — including Volvo Cars (first role post-Chalmers) and AstraZeneca — and a track record of building scalable design capability in both fast-scaling technology companies and large consulting organisations. Known for connecting insight to strategy, aligning cross-functional stakeholders, and raising the maturity of design and product functions from the inside out.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Digital Experience Strategy

Product Discovery

Design Leadership

Organisational Transformation

Capability Building

Cross-functional Alignment

Stakeholder Management

Design Operations

Engineering Collaboration

Experience Governance

Systems Thinking

Insight-driven Prioritisation

Coaching & Mentoring Leaders

Design Maturity

Service Design

Journey Orchestration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SLEEP CYCLE

2024, Present

Consumer health technology · Global ·
Gothenburg · 40-person company ·
Discovery lead across 4 product
teams

UX & Discovery Lead · *Senior Product Designer*

- Served as discovery lead across four product teams in a 40-person company, creating a shared discovery practice where none previously existed and sustaining it continuously for 18 months.
- Established and maintained a weekly user interview cadence without interruption, building organisational muscle for continuous learning and making discovery a reliable input to product decisions rather than an occasional event.
- Developed JTBD-based user archetypes that created shared language between design, product, and engineering, reducing misalignment in prioritisation and increasing the speed of problem framing.
- Built a scalable knowledge infrastructure in Notion connecting qualitative research, quantitative signals, and product decisions, enabling all four teams to draw on a living body of customer insight.
- Drove cross-functional alignment between design, product management, and engineering on customer problems and opportunity areas, reducing rework and improving the quality of product bets.

CARBONCLOUD

2020, 2024

Climate tech · B2B SaaS · Gothenburg ·
~4.5 years · Grew 10 → 45 people

Head of Product · *VP of UX · UX Designer*

- Joined as the first design hire when the company was 10 people and grew with the organisation to 45, taking on increasing strategic responsibility and ultimately leading product as Head of Product, managing a product team of three at peak.
- Defined and led product strategy in close collaboration with founders and commercial leadership, aligning product direction with market development and sustainability-driven customer demands.
- Introduced and evolved product-led growth frameworks across the company, leading product strategy, roadmapping, and growth modelling in close collaboration with founders and commercial leadership.
- Built product and UX capability from zero: establishing research practices, design operations, and cross-

functional working methods suited to a scaling scaleup environment.

- Sustained close collaboration between product, design, and engineering throughout rapid commercial growth, maintaining quality and coherence as the team and platform expanded.

INUSE

2012, 2020

Design & innovation consultancy · ~120 people · Gothenburg · ~8 years

Chief Design Officer · *UX Director* · *Interaction Designer*

- Progressed from practitioner to Chief Design Officer, leading a design function of over 120 people across five Design Directors, responsible for capability, culture, quality, and strategic positioning.
- Drove the evolution of design competence as inUse grew from a 60-person senior-only agency to a 120-person organisation capable of recruiting and developing junior talent internally, introducing skills-based recruitment testing, structured competence sharing between designers, and assignment processes that balanced learning with delivery quality.
- Coached and developed five Design Directors, building their capacity for strategic leadership, client influence, and team development, creating a leadership layer that could operate with significant autonomy.
- Elevated design maturity across the organisation through practice development, knowledge-sharing infrastructure, and standardised ways of working that scaled across studios and engagement types.
- Led design strategy for complex enterprise clients across regulated industries, navigating matrix organisations, multi-stakeholder environments, and technically constrained delivery contexts.
- As UX Director and senior practitioner, led high-stakes projects for AstraZeneca and other complex organisations, building deep capability in enterprise-scale UX, regulated environments, and long-cycle stakeholder engagement — drawing also on early-career exposure to automotive UX at Volvo Cars.

LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

SCALING DESIGN ORGANISATIONS

As CDO at inUse, led a 120-person design organisation with five direct Design Director reports, building the leadership layer, coaching capacity, and organisational structure to scale quality without losing culture.

DISCOVERY AS ORG CAPABILITY

At Sleep Cycle, built and sustained a continuous discovery practice across four product teams for 18 months, establishing a weekly interview cadence from scratch and creating the knowledge infrastructure that connected user insight to product decisions company-wide.

PRODUCT STRATEGY LEADERSHIP

At CarbonCloud, joined as the first design hire when the company was 10 people. Grew into Head of Product as the organisation scaled to 45, setting strategic direction, managing a product team of three, and keeping discovery central throughout rapid commercial growth.

ENTERPRISE COMPLEXITY

Hands-on experience inside both Volvo Cars (early-career UX Designer) and AstraZeneca (senior practitioner via inUse), spanning automotive engineering organisations, regulated pharma environments, and multi-level stakeholder complexity.

OUTCOME-ORIENTED PLANNING

Led product strategy, roadmapping, and growth modelling at CarbonCloud, introducing product-led growth frameworks that connected commercial goals to product decisions throughout a period of rapid scaling.

TRANSFORMATION LEADERSHIP

Consistent record of repositioning design and product functions, shifting organisations from delivery focus toward strategic contribution, and building the internal credibility for design to influence at executive level.

SELECTED ENTERPRISE EXPERIENCE

VOLVO CARS

Automotive · Engineering-led · via inUse

First professional role after graduating from Chalmers, working as a UX Designer on digital automotive products inside an engineering-led matrix organisation. Gained foundational experience in complex stakeholder environments, technical constraints, and long product development cycles — formative exposure to the kind of organisational complexity that defines large industrial companies.

ASTRAZENECA

Pharmaceutical · Regulated · via inUse

UX design and research leadership within a regulated, compliance-driven environment. Experience managing the intersection of patient safety requirements, clinical workflows, and digital product quality, demonstrating the ability to operate effectively where

design decisions carry material organisational and human consequences.

INUSE CLIENTS

Various enterprise · Sweden & Europe

Broad enterprise consulting experience across industrial, healthcare, financial, and public sector clients, providing sustained exposure to complex organisational dynamics, technical environments, and the challenge of embedding design thinking into organisations not originally built around it.

EDUCATION

CHALMERS UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

M.Sc. Industrial Design Engineering · Minor in Cognitive Ergonomics

2005 – 2010

TOOLS, METHODS & PRACTICES

DISCOVERY & RESEARCH

Continuous Discovery, JTBD, opportunity mapping, assumption testing, user interviews, behavioural analysis, insight operationalisation

STRATEGY & GOVERNANCE

Outcome-based roadmaps, OKRs, experience governance, design operations, design maturity frameworks, service design, journey orchestration

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Figma, Notion, Dovetail, Miro, Productboard, Claude / ChatGPT (AI-assisted workflows), analytics platforms